

Death, Taxes, and Layoffs

I GOT AN EMAIL from a former co-worker offering “overwhelming evidence” that global warming was a hoax. The proof? A letter signed by 49 former NASA scientists.^{[128](#)}

That numerator all by itself sent my Spidey-sense atwitchin.

What’s the denominator? That’s the first question you should ask yourself. How many scientists have worked at NASA? Not just climatologists or meteorologists, but anyone with an advanced technical degree in hard sciences or engineering that was similar to those 49 climate hoaxers listed.

NASA currently employs about 18,000 people. Since NASA began in 1958 with 8,000 workers, they have had many tens of thousands of employees.^{[129](#)}

During the Apollo program, NASA’s workforce peaked at over 400,000 employees, contractors, and support personnel. And across its history, about half of its employees had professional degrees. Conservative guess as to how many scientists and engineers worked for NASA? More than 100,000 people at the least.

Of all these people, living and dead, 49 got together and wrote a letter.

Now that we have some context, that letter touting only 49 people looks silly. This handful—only one of whom works as a meteorologist—are an extremely tiny percentage of current (or former) NASA employees. If you invert the math, it proves the opposite: Out of hundreds of thousands of NASA scientists and engineers, you could only find 49 that endorse your debunked hoax theory?

Always be suspicious when you see a single number out of context—too often, it is a tool of deception.

Tech layoffs

Following a massive hiring spree in 2021, 2022, and 2023, many of the